

People Analytics Office Hours

Overview

People Analytics Office Hours provide a regular, accessible forum where GitLab team members can receive direct support and guidance from the People Analytics team. These sessions are designed to democratize data access, improve data literacy across the organization, and enhance collaboration between the People Analytics team and business stakeholders.

Purpose

To create an open, supportive environment where team members can:

- Get immediate assistance with data-related questions
- Receive hands-on analytics support
- Learn about available People Analytics resources and services
- Collaborate on potential analysis opportunities
- Build confidence in data utilization and interpretation

What We Cover

Data Analysis Support

- Troubleshooting data questions and interpretation challenges
- Guidance on statistical approaches and methodology
- Help with data validation and quality assessment
- Support for advanced analytics requests
- Chart selection and design principles

Tableau Dashboard Assistance

- Navigation tips and best practices for existing dashboards
- Custom view creation and filtering techniques
- Understanding metric definitions and calculations
- Troubleshooting access issues and permissions

Spreadsheet Solutions

- Formula assistance and automation techniques
- Data cleaning and transformation guidance
- Integration tips for connecting spreadsheets to other tools
- Template sharing and standardization

Strategic Consultation

- Exploration of new analysis opportunities
- Discussion of research questions and hypotheses
- Guidance on data collection and measurement strategies
- Overview of People Analytics service offerings - just to learn about us and what we do

Session Details

Schedule & Format

- Frequency: Every 2 weeks (alternating time zones)
- Duration: 30 minutes
- Format: Zoom call
- Agenda: Notes and conversation will be documented in the agenda

Timing Options

To accommodate GitLab's global workforce, we alternate between different time zones:

- Rotation 1: Wednesdays, 8:30 AM PT / 11:30 AM ET / 3:30 PM UTC
- Rotation 2: Wednesdays, 11:00 AM PT / 2:00 PM ET / 6:00 PM UTC

How to Participate

Before the Session

1. Submit Questions: If possible, add your questions or topics to the agenda ahead of time. If not, no worries, just show up with your questions or discussion topics
2. Prepare Materials: If you have specific dashboards, reports, or data you'd like to discuss, have them ready to screen share
3. Review Resources: Check our People Analytics Tableau Dashboard Overview if your question relates to existing dashboards

During the Session

- Questions are typically addressed in the order they appear on the agenda
- Feel free to ask questions that come to mind in the moment
- Take advantage of the collaborative environment to learn from others' questions, no need to ask anything specific if you'd just like to join the conversation to listen

After the Session

- If more support is needed, feel free to set up time with the People Analytics team or submit an issue for additional support async

Getting Help Between Sessions

While Office Hours provide regular touchpoints, don't hesitate to reach out between sessions for:

- Urgent Requests: Use our People Analytics project issue templates
- Quick Questions: Reach out directly through Slack in the #people-analytics channel
- Complex Projects: Schedule dedicated sync meeting to talk through your needs

Resources & Preparation

Recommended Reading

- People Analytics Data Guide - Understand our data models and metrics, specifically our Data Dictionary
- People Analytics Tableau Dashboard Overview - Familiarize yourself with available dashboards

Expected Outcomes

We strive to ensure these sessions are a valuable use of time. We track the effectiveness of Office Hours through:

Impact Measurement

- Reduction in individual support requests through email/Slack
- Improvement in Tableau dashboard usage metrics - monitored on this dashboard
- Follow-up project requests generated from sessions - tracked with the PA-office-hours label in our project tracker

Knowledge Transfer Indicators

- Repeat question patterns (decreasing indicates improved understand and usage of resources)
- Complexity evolution of submitted questions
- Self-service success rates for common tasks - less attendance is an indication most questions are being answered without the need to reach out

Feedback & Continuous Improvement

Your feedback drives the evolution of these sessions so please let us know what is or is not working. We regularly:

- Adjust timing and frequency based on attendance patterns
- Develop new resources based on commonly asked questions
- Iterate on session structure to maximize value

FAQ

<details><summary>Click to expand FAQ</summary>

Who can attend?

Office Hours are open to all GitLab team members, with content particularly relevant for people managers, business team members, and anyone working with people data.

What if I can't attend live?

All sessions are recorded and made available within 24 hours. The agenda and any shared resources are also distributed post-session.

How technical can my questions be?

All levels welcome! We tailor explanations to your technical background and can provide both high-level insights and detailed technical guidance.

Can I request specific topics for future sessions?

Absolutely! Submit topic requests through the agenda document or reach out to the People Analytics team directly.

What if my question requires sensitive data discussion?

While Office Hours are great for general guidance, questions involving sensitive individual data should be handled through private consultations. Reach out to us directly to schedule dedicated time.

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